



MEDLEX

The CASC Academy

COURSE GUIDE · 2026-27

The CASC Academy

Learn the CASC from the examiner's side of the table.

An online CASC preparation course, built by a former examiner. 43 interactive stations, each shown failed two ways and passed once, with the examiner's reasoning at every decision.

43 STATIONS

8 DOMAINS

12-WEEK WORKBOOK

6 MONTHS' ACCESS

Most candidates who fail have already read enough.

They have the textbooks. They have watched the videos. They can describe a risk assessment accurately — at a desk, on their own, with no clock running.

Then they walk into a station where a woman is packing her bag to go home, and something she says at minute three changes what the station is actually about — and nothing they revised tells them what to do in the next four seconds.

The CASC is a performance examination. It tests what comes out of your mouth, under time, in front of someone who is marking you. Reading is the cheapest form of preparation to consume, and the least likely to change your score.

The Academy is built the other way round: every station makes you watch the mistake happen, understand why it costs the mark, and then make the decisions yourself.



THE EXAMINER'S QUESTION

“Would I be confident to have this candidate as my registrar? That is the question behind every mark — and the lens every station here is marked through.”

Who it is for

- MRCPsych CASC candidates on their first attempt
- Candidates preparing to resit, who need to know what went wrong
- Candidates for other observed psychiatry examinations, including the Arab Board and national OSCEs
- Trainers who want a structured way to run practice sessions

Who it is not for

- Anyone looking for model answers to memorise
- Anyone who wants to read about stations rather than practise them

Stations here are not scripts. They teach the reasoning that lets you handle a patient you have never met.

Three steps, from enrolment to exam day

1 Enrol

One payment, 6 months' access.
Start the same day on your phone, tablet or laptop — all 43 stations open from the first login.



2 Work through the stations

About 45 minutes each in Learn Mode, then a timed 7-minute Exam Mode on a patient you have not met.



3 Practise with colleagues

Every station ends with cards for a three-person practice session — candidate, role-player and observer.

12 Weeks to the CASC Workbook — included, and guides you through all three steps, week by week.

What you get

The station library

43 stations across 8 domains. Each is shown failed two ways and passed once, with the examiner's reasoning and 7 decisions for you to make.

Learn Mode and Exam Mode

Study a station properly, then prove the skill transfers: 7 minutes, timed, on a new patient, with no feedback and no second try.

43 practice packs

Candidate, role-player and observer cards for every station — to print or open on a phone for practice sessions.

The workbook

12 Weeks to the CASC: four routes depending on the time you have, weekly planners, a station log, a domain tracker, and a chapter for resitting.

The candidates' group

A WhatsApp group whose whole purpose is finding two colleagues free on the same evening — the problem that actually stops practice.

The examiner's notes and certificate

Short emails through your preparation, and a certificate of completion when you finish the library.

AVAILABLE SEPARATELY

One-to-one coaching

For a weakness that will not shift on its own: live, timed stations with the examiner, and specific feedback on what you say.

How a station works

Not lectures. Not model answers. Every station is built the same way, around the specific error that costs candidates the mark — and then you make the decisions yourself.

1 The trap, named

Every station opens by saying what it is really testing — and the two ways good candidates lose the mark. Most stations are not about what they appear to be about.

2 Two failures, one pass

The same seven minutes, three times, line by line. The first failure is the obvious one. The second is the kind, reasonable failure — and it is the one most candidates recognise in themselves.

3 The examiner's reasoning

Beside many lines is a small gold circle. Tap it to read what the examiner is thinking at that exact moment — why the mark is being won or lost, as it happens.

4 Seven decisions

Then you are in the chair. Choose what to say, read the examiner's response, and try again until you find the move that works. Every wrong answer has its own feedback.

5 Exam Mode, then the cards

A different patient, a timed seven minutes, no help. Then a three-person practice pack to run with colleagues that evening.

An example: Station 7.2, The Angry Father

FAIL 1 · THE DEFENCE

Every fact correct, every policy cited — and the fear underneath the anger never found.

FAIL 2 · THE SURRENDER

Sounds like good practice. Look at what was given away to calm the room.

THE PASS

The same minutes, done in the order that works: the man heard first, the facts after.

Station 7.2 is open to anyone, free, with no login — see the back page.

Study it. Then prove it.

ABOUT 45 MINUTES

Learn Mode

Where you study. Read the three takes in order, open every gold circle, and make the seven decisions until each one is right. You are meant to stop, choose, and be wrong.

7 MINUTES, TIMED

Exam Mode

Where you find out. A patient you have not met, the clock running, no feedback and no second try. Knowing the answer for one patient proves memory; Exam Mode shows whether the skill transfers. Best taken a day or two after Learn Mode.

The CASC is spoken out loud

Nothing on a screen replaces saying it to another person. Every station ends with a three-person practice pack — a new case, built to punish the same trap.

Candidate card

The task exactly as you would receive it on the day, and the seven minutes to do it.

Role-player card

The patient's hidden story, what they reveal only if asked well, and the lines that punish the wrong approach.

Observer card

An examiner-style rubric: the overall judgement first, then the specific points that decide it.

No one to practise with? Ask in the candidates' WhatsApp group — finding two people free on the same evening is exactly what it is for.

Watch your progress by domain

Your course home shows stations completed and Exam Modes passed, broken down by domain. The number that matters is not the total — it is your weakest domain. Work that one next, even when another is more enjoyable.

Domain 3 · Risk Assessment

4 of 7 stations · 2 Exam Modes passed



Eight domains. Forty-three stations.

The library is organised by what the examiner is marking, not by diagnosis. A lithium station is really an information-giving station — and learning to see that is half of passing.

1 Communication & Rapport

The first minute, and everything that depends on it · 4 stations

1.1 The Simple Station

1.2 Nothing Is Wrong

1.3 Working with an Interpreter

1.4 Medically Unexplained Symptoms

2 Information Giving

Explaining so the patient can decide · 6 stations

2.1 Starting Lithium

2.2 Clozapine

2.3 Explaining Schizophrenia

2.4 ECT Explained

2.5 Antidepressants in Pregnancy

2.6 Panic Disorder and Explaining CBT

3 Risk Assessment

The flagship domain — one competency behind many disguises · 7 stations

3.1 After an Overdose

3.2 The Violent Inpatient

3.3 Domestic Abuse Enquiry

3.4 Child at Risk

3.5 The Vulnerable Adult

3.6 Fire Setting

3.7 Stalking and Erotomania

4 Mental State Examination

History, mental state, and what the referral missed · 11 stations

4.1 Hearing Voices

4.2 Elated and Spending

4.3 Confused on the Ward

4.4 The Memory Clinic

4.5 Obsessions and Rituals

4.6 Low Weight

4.7 Adult ADHD Assessment

4.8 Autism Assessment in an Adult

4.9 PTSD Assessment

4.10 Alcohol Dependence

4.11 Behavioural Change in Learning Disability

THE LIBRARY, CONTINUED

5 Capacity, Consent & the Law

When the patient says no · 4 stations

5.1 Refusing Treatment

5.2 I'm Leaving

5.3 The Relative Who Wants Everything

5.4 Sectioned

6 Management & Emergencies

Deciding under pressure, and saying it clearly · 4 stations

6.1 The Agitated Patient

6.2 The Lithium Toxicity Call

6.3 Postpartum Psychosis

6.4 The Overdose Handover

7 Difficult Conversations

Anger, grief, complaint — and the word no · 4 stations

7.1 The Patient Who Won't Take No

7.2 The Angry Father

7.3 Breaking Bad News

7.4 The Complaint and the Apology

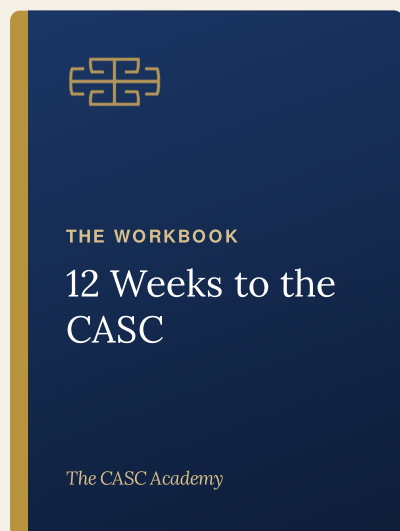
8 Physical Examination

Examining with the patient, not at them · 3 stations

8.1 Extraparamidal Side-Effects

8.2 Cardiovascular Baseline

8.3 Cranial Nerves



INCLUDED

The workbook turns 43 stations into a plan

- **Four routes**, depending on the weeks you have left
- **Twelve weekly planner pages** and a station log
- **A domain tracker** and mock-debrief sheets
- **A chapter for the last fourteen days**, and one for candidates resitting

Download it on the first day and fill in page one before you open station two. Candidates who plan finish the library; candidates who browse do not.

THE EXAMINER



Dr Ahmed Abouelghit

UK-trained Consultant Forensic Psychiatrist · formerly a CASC examiner

He has sat on the examiner's side of the CASC table and directs specialist psychiatry training. Every station, every piece of examiner reasoning and every practice pack in the Academy was written by him.

START HERE

Try a station before you decide.

Station 7.2, The Angry Father, is open to anyone — free, complete, no login. Read it fail twice, read it pass, open the examiner's reasoning, and make the seven decisions yourself.

With it comes **The Examiner's Briefing**: how the CASC is actually marked, from the other side of the table.



Try the free station, or
enrol

Independent preparation. The CASC Academy is not endorsed by, affiliated with or approved by the Royal College of Psychiatrists. It contains no examination material: every station and case is original and fictional. Course content is in English, the language of the examination.



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